

To whom it may concern at Figma,

I am writing to outline my distinct skill set, which aptly positions me as a strong candidate for this Data Engineering role. I am an extremely voracious learner, having earned two undergraduate and one graduate degree in five years, as well as accelerating from a Python novice to a Data Engineer in less than a year and a half. In addition to writing over ten thousand lines of code by hand, I am also adept at leveraging new tools, such as Claude, Gemini, and Copilot, to accelerate my work and place in the top 5 of 27 in our portfolio-wide AI competition. As a curious and motivated tinkerer and builder, I know I would fit right in at Figma.

My current role as a Data Engineer at Grassroots Carbon has been characterized by immense growth and self-driven skill acquisition, from soil carbon to coding. I have quickly acquired skills in Docker containerization, automating deployment using cron and GitHub Actions, hitting APIs (such as Salesforce), building ETL pipelines from start to finish, designing front-end applications using Streamlit, and using Pydantic framework for data validation. I tackle problems as I encounter them, often before they become business critical issues. In my day-to-day role, I develop modeling pipelines for soil carbon reductions and removals in python, write and rewrite code until it is clean and documented, complete numerous pull request reviews for colleagues, and read literature to enhance industry-specific knowledge.

I have ample background in a wide variety of data, from economics to ranching, in the form of big, often geospatial datasets. In my current role, I have processed a dozen datasets on Uber's H3 hexagonal spatial indexing system and stored the resulting parquets on AWS S3. I have a proven track record of being intellectually nimble; I am able to pivot and get up to speed quickly, regardless of the magnitude of the challenge I'm facing. My professional goal is to always continue learning through solving complex problems that bring ideas to life, improve efficiency, and build a better world.

My mantra, both in personal and professional life, is "I can do hard things." I embody this daily by meditating, cold plunging, weightlifting, and practicing other habits and routines, which I track in a personal app I built specifically for optimizing my life. I am a go-getter, a powerhouse, a never-back-down kind of person. I am confident in my abilities to learn new skills and hone those I already possess. I strive to surround myself with smart, hardworking, high quality humans who treat others with respect and share the same goals. I truly believe I would be a great fit for this role, this team, and this company.

Thank you for considering my application; I look forward to discussing the role further.

Best,

Katherine (Katy) Yut

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Katy Yut', with a stylized, cursive script.